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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, AUSTRIAN CHANCELLOR DISCUSS COOPERATION

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Christian Stocker, Chancellor of Austria. During the meeting, the leaders discussed cooperation and opportunities to expand ties, particularly in the economic, development, industrial, renewable energy, technology, and artificial intelligence sectors, among other areas that support development priorities and mutual interests under the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between the two countries.

IRAN TARGETS GULF STATES, VESSELS AMID ESCALATION

UAE intercepts UAVs, Tehran warns US

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Drones targeted Gulf states and commercial vessels yesterday as Iran warned the United States that its “restraint is over”, threatening retaliation against American ships and bases even as Tehran responded to Washington’s latest peace proposal.

The UAE announced that its air defence systems intercepted two drones launched from Iran, while Qatar confirmed a drone strike on a commercial vessel arriving from Abu Dhabi. The UAE Ministry of Defence said no injuries were reported. Since the start of the blatant Iranian attacks, UAE air defences had intercepted 551 ballistic missiles, 29 cruise missiles and 2,265 drones.

Kuwait also reported a drone incident. The Kuwaiti military said hostile drones had entered its airspace at dawn and were intercepted. The incidents marked another dangerous escalation around the Strait of Hormuz, where Iran and the US are increasingly confronting each other over shipping and maritime access.

‘Dangerous escalation’

Qatar said a drone struck a cargo vessel northeast of Me-saied Port after it entered the country’s territorial waters. Qatar called it a “dangerous and unacceptable escalation”.

Tensions intensified after reports that a US fighter jet fired on and disabled two Iran-flagged vessels in the Gulf of Oman on Friday.

Iranian officials responded with a series of threats. “Our restraint is over as of today,” Ebrahim Rezaei, spokesman for the Iranian parliament’s national security commission,

PRESIDENT’S LEADERSHIP STYLE HAILED

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has commended the leadership style of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, describing him as a leader who is closely connected to people through regular public engagement and direct interaction with citizens.

In remarks shared on X, Gargash said Sheikh Mohamed was among the region’s most prominent leaders who “lead from the field”, noting that he finds genuine joy in meeting people and listening to them directly. Gargash said hundreds of people attend the President’s weekly majlis gatherings, while his visits to citizens continue regularly in “diverse and consistent ways”.

He added that Sheikh Mohamed’s recent tour alongside Abdul Fattah Al Sissi at a shopping centre reflected a long-established approach characterised by spontaneity, simplicity and distance from excessive formality. “Such moments are not the exception, but rather part of his enduring style of leadership,” Gargash wrote.

He said the qualities of closeness to people, humility and simplicity represent the hallmarks of genuine leadership, particularly during exceptional periods that require reinforcing public confidence and reassurance.

—Gulf News Report

wrote in a social media post. “Any attack on our vessels will trigger a strong and decisive Iranian response against American ships and bases.”

Iran’s Revolutionary Guards also warned that any future attack on Iranian tankers or commercial vessels would result in “a heavy attack” on US regional interests and ships.

Iran also warned Britain and France yesterday that its armed forces would launch “a decisive and immediate response” to any warships being sent to the Strait of Hormuz, after Paris and London despatched vessels to the region. Military chief Ali Abdollahi met Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei and received “new directives and guidance for the continuation of operations to confront the enemy”.

Amid the growing tensions, the UAE rejected any attempt to impose transit fees or restrictions on ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz.

Speaking at the UN, UAE Permanent Representative Mohamed Abushahab said international

maritime corridors could not be subjected to coercion.

Strike ‘every single target’

US President Donald Trump meanwhile said that American forces could strike “every single target” in Iran within two weeks if necessary. “They’re militarily defeated,” Trump said, adding that the US had already struck “probably 70 per cent” of intended targets.

The tensions unfolded as Iran sent its response to a new US ceasefire proposal through Pakistani mediators. According to Iranian media, Tehran wants negotiations to focus first on permanently ending the war and guaranteeing maritime security before discussing its nuclear programme.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the war with Iran was “not over” and insisted Tehran’s enriched uranium stockpile must be removed and its enrichment sites dismantled before the conflict can truly end.

SEE ALSO P5, 6, 8, 12

Schools and universities restart in-person classes

Ministry will continue to ensure a smooth return to classroom learning

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Ministry of Education has announced the resumption of in-person learning for all students, teachers and administrative staff in public and private schools, as well as nurseries across the UAE, effective today.

In a statement, the ministry said the decision followed continuous monitoring of developments and coordination with relevant authorities to ensure the continuity of the educational process and academic assessments.

The ministry affirmed that educational institutions would continue implementing approved safety and security protocols and procedures to support the smooth continuation of classes.

Alternative learning models

Authorities said schools and nurseries would also remain prepared to activate alternative learning models if required, depending on ongoing devel-

opments and continuous assessments. The Ministry of Education said coordination with educational institutions nationwide would continue to ensure a smooth return to classroom learning. The Ministry of Higher Education and Scientific Research has also announced that all public and private universities and higher education institutions across the UAE will resume in-person learning from today.

The decision applies to students, academic staff and administrative employees nationwide following a temporary period of remote learning introduced as a precautionary measure amid heightened regional tensions.

The announcement comes after schools, universities and nurseries across the UAE temporarily shifted to remote learning from May 5 to 8.

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